



Mastering the Art of Essay Writing

How to Share Your Big Ideas Clearly

Our Learning Goals

Today we are going to learn how to:

- Understand the key parts of an essay.
- Organise our ideas into clear paragraphs.
- Use strong arguments to persuade our reader.
- Write a powerful introduction and a firm conclusion.



Words Every Writer Needs



Introduction

Introduction: The opening paragraph stating the topic and thesis.



Argument

A set of reasons aimed at persuading others that an idea is right or wrong.



Structure

Essay organization into beginning, middle, and end.



Conclusion

The final paragraph that sums up the main points and leaves the reader with a final thought.

The 'Hamburger' Method



Building Your Essay

Think of an essay like a burger!

- **The Top Bun:** Your Introduction. It holds everything together.
- **The Filling:** Your Body Paragraphs. This is the 'meat' or main arguments.
- **The Bottom Bun:** Your Conclusion. It finishes the meal.

Why Structure Matters

Without a plan, your reader might get lost. Good structure ensures ideas flow smoothly.

Check Your Knowledge

1.

Introduction

a) The 'hook' that starts the essay.

2.

Argument

b) A point used to persuade the reader.

3.

Conclusion

c) The skeleton or layout of the essay.

4.

Structure

d) The final wrap-up of all ideas.

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Crafting the Introduction

The Hook

Start with something catchy! Ask a question or share a surprising fact to grab the reader's attention.

The Thesis Statement

This is a fancy name for your **main point**. Tell the reader exactly what you believe about the topic right away.

The Roadmap

Briefly mention the three main points you will talk about. It prepares the reader for the journey ahead.



The Perfect Body Paragraph

Point

Start with a topic sentence that explains the main idea of this paragraph.



Evidence

Provide facts, statistics, or examples to prove your point is true.

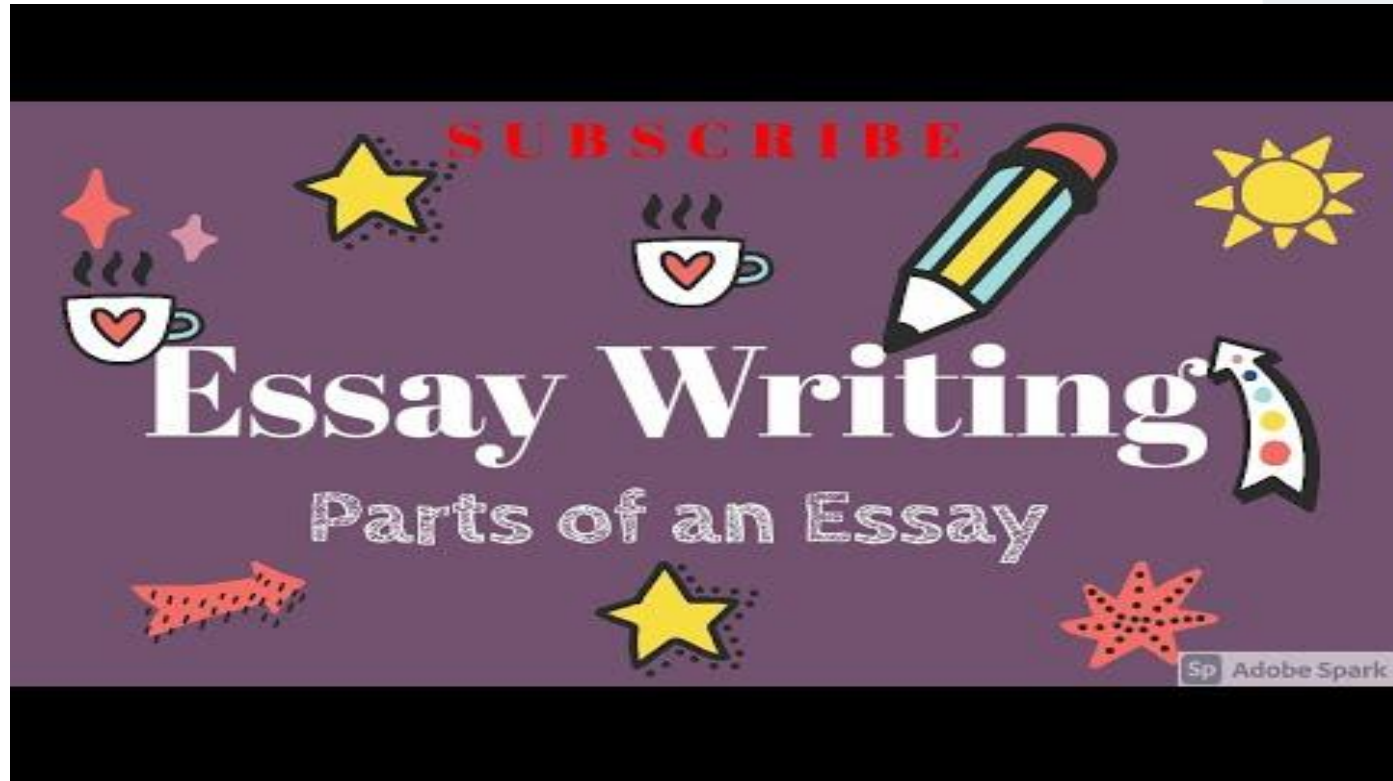


Explanation

Explain how your evidence proves your point and connects back to your essay topic.



Watch: How to Write an Essay



Let's Debate!



Imagine you are writing an essay on this topic: 'Should primary school students wear uniforms?' What are three strong arguments you could use for either side?

Let's Debate!



You might have said...

Uniforms prevent bullying over clothes and foster team spirit.

They save parents time each morning.

However, they can be costly and limit self-expression.

They may also be uncomfortable in hot Australian summers.

The Power of Persuasion



Choosing Your Words

To strengthen essays, use High Modality words to show certainty.

- **Weak:** I think, maybe, perhaps.
- **Strong:** Certainly, definitely, must, will.

Connectives

Use 'Signpost' words to link ideas:

- *Furthermore* (to add info)
- *However* (to show contrast)
- *Consequently* (to show results)

Ordering a Paragraph

Answers on the next slide...

Put these sentences in the correct order to make a perfect PEEL (Point, Evidence, Explanation, Link) paragraph.

This proves that moving our bodies helps us live longer lives.

Studies show that 30 minutes of running daily reduces heart disease risk.

Therefore, schools should ensure daily PE lessons occur.

Firstly, exercise is vital for maintaining a healthy heart.

Ordering a Paragraph



Put these sentences in the correct order to make a perfect PEEL (Point, Evidence, Explanation, Link) paragraph.

Firstly, exercise is vital for maintaining a healthy heart.

1.

Studies show that 30 minutes of running daily reduces heart disease risk.

2.

This proves that moving our bodies helps us live longer lives.

3.

Therefore, schools should ensure daily PE lessons occur.

4.

Ending with a Bang

The Conclusion

Your conclusion shouldn't just repeat yourself—it should leave an impression!

1. **Summarise:** Briefly remind the reader of your three main arguments.
2. **Restate:** Say your main point one last time, but use different words.
3. **Final Thought:** Leave the reader with a 'call to action' or a powerful closing sentence that makes them keep thinking about your essay.



Quick Review



Question 1:

What is the 'Top Bun' of our essay structure called?

Question 2:

Which type of words show you are certain (e.g., 'definitely', 'must')?

Question 3:

True or False: You should introduce brand new arguments in your conclusion.

Answers on the next slide...

Quick Review



Answer 1:

The Introduction

Answer 2:

High modality words

Answer 3:

False (Conclusions should only summarise existing points).

Summary: You're Ready to Write!



You've Got This!

Writing an essay is just like building a house. You need a solid **foundation** (your introduction), strong **walls** (your body paragraphs), and a **roof** to finish it off (your conclusion).

Remember to:

- Plan your structure before you start.
- Use evidence to support your big ideas.
- Write with confidence using strong words.